ENG-0001 Incident Postmortem: INC-017

Impact

The incident identified as INC-017 affected the `auth-api` system, which is part of Project Titan. The `auth-api` system, owned by project P-021, has a criticality classified as medium. The incident was classified as Sev1, indicating a severe impact on system functionality. The primary consequence was a disruption in authentication services, which could have affected user access and internal operations reliant on the `auth-api`. The resolution of this incident was achieved within 1.5 hours, minimizing prolonged service disruption.

Timeline

- **2025-02-09**: The incident was reported by Daniel Wagner, Head of Legal, via the internal monitoring and incident reporting channels.
- **Incident Detection**: The issue was identified as a result of a configuration change that led to the failure.
- **Response Activation**: Cameron Parker, a Financial Analyst and the on-call engineer for `auth-api`, was alerted to the incident.
- **Resolution**: The root cause was addressed through a configuration correction, restoring normal operation.
- **Resolution Time**: The incident was resolved within 1.5 hours from detection.

Root Cause

The root cause of INC-017 was a configuration change within the `auth-api` system. This change was identified as the primary factor leading to the service disruption. The configuration modification was not properly validated before deployment, resulting in the system's failure to operate correctly. This category of root cause falls under "config_change," highlighting the importance of rigorous change management processes.

Action Items

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Review and strengthen change management procedures for `auth-api` configuration updates	Project Titan Lead (E-097)	Immediate	Ensure all configuration changes undergo thorough review and testing prior to deployment.
Implement additional monitoring and alerting for configuration anomalies in `auth-api`	DevOps Team	Within 2 weeks	Enhance detection capabilities to prevent similar issues from escalating.
Conduct a post-incident review session with Cameron Parker and relevant stakeholders	Project Titan Management	Within 1 week	Discuss response effectiveness and areas for improvement.

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Document and communicate best practices for configuration changes across all systems	Project Titan Documentation Team	Ongoing	Promote awareness of change management standards.

Additional Notes

This incident underscores the critical importance of strict adherence to change management protocols, especially for systems with medium criticality like `auth-api`. Cameron Parker, the on-call engineer, responded promptly, enabling resolution within a short timeframe. Moving forward, the team will focus on enhancing change validation processes and monitoring systems to mitigate the risk of recurrence. Daniel Wagner, as the incident reporter, provided timely notification, facilitating swift response.

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